

James "Wes" Etheredge, MBA

San Antonio, TX 78254 | (210) 544-6718 | wes.etheredge@protonmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/wesetheredge>

AI/ML, Data, Analytics, and Cloud Leader

Data, Analytics, and AI/ML Leader with 20+ years of experience leading enterprise-scale analytics, cloud modernization, and machine learning initiatives across the financial services, defense, and technology sectors. Architected scalable ML and MLOps platforms, implemented enterprise data governance frameworks, and modernized legacy infrastructure, achieving multimillion-dollar cost savings and measurable performance gains. Experienced in Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS, and hybrid environments with extensive hands-on delivery in Python, data engineering, and ML pipeline automation. Led and developed high-performing teams of up to 70 professionals while aligning technical strategy with business objectives. Currently conducting applied research in agentic AI systems using Anthropic Claude, ChatGPT, N8N, and Ollama to advance autonomous analytics capabilities.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI and ML Program Management, Enterprise Data Strategy, Cloud Cost Optimization, Process Automation, Model Governance and Risk Management, Regulatory Compliance, Cross-Functional Leadership, Talent Development, Executive Communication, Strategic Roadmap Development, Stakeholder Alignment, AI Governance, and Data Quality Frameworks.

EXPERIENCE

CONFIDENTIAL CLIENTS | San Antonio, TX (Remote)

08/2025-Present

Generative and Agentic AI Strategist

- Architected and deployed multi-agent AI frameworks across GCP, AWS, and Microsoft Copilot Agent ecosystems, defining agent taxonomies, orchestration patterns, and governance standards to enable scalable, production-ready agentic systems for federal and commercial clients.
 - Achieved an 80%+ cycle-time reduction and 95%+ cost reduction, saving at least \$1M/yr and freeing 5 FTE, by way of a single agentic AI workflow.
- Authored agentic AI guides, decision rubrics (when to use agents vs. traditional automation), and frameworks establishing standards for agent skill modularity, prompt orchestration, context injection strategies, and agent memory architectures to ensure interoperability and governance across business lines.
- Partnered with executives across Marketing Data & Analytics, Product Management, and other programs to translate AI vision into sequenced roadmaps with measurable quarterly deliverables, balancing innovation velocity with commercial outcomes and regulatory compliance.
- Conducted data and AI maturity assessments for client organizations, evaluating existing implementations, model readiness, and architectural gaps, then developed multi-year transformation roadmaps evolving analytics capabilities from descriptive reporting through predictive, generative, and prescriptive intelligence.
- Prototyped and validated multi-agent coordination patterns including delegation hierarchies, swarm collaboration, and event-driven architectures, moving concepts rapidly from proof-of-concept through pilot to production deployment with full observability and auditability.
- Built and evangelized internal AI literacy programs, conducting executive workshops and technical enablement sessions to foster organization-wide understanding of agentic AI concepts, capabilities, and strategic implications.
- Delivered scalable generative AI solutions using LLMs, automation pipelines, RAG, and API integrations across multiple Agent platforms, optimizing for performance, cost efficiency, and enterprise security requirements.
- Proposed and socialized Scrumban-based operating models tailored to AI engineering and infrastructure work, improving alignment between volatile AI discovery cycles and leadership planning and accountability needs.
- Authored several executive-ready whitepapers for AI initiatives including coding assistant deployments, M365 Copilot enablement, and sales enablement tooling, quantifying impact on developer productivity, sales effectiveness, and data sovereignty/compliance posture.

WELLS FARGO | San Antonio, TX

07/2023-08/2025

Senior Specialty Engineering Manager (Executive Director)

- Directed enterprise-wide Google Cloud Platform (GCP) solution design and automation initiatives, leading multiple scrum teams to speed up cloud adoption, modernize infrastructure, and resolve critical audit findings across data and ML workloads.
- Spearheaded GCP tenant onboarding and customer experience redesign, reducing onboarding time by over 70% and increasing delivery throughput tenfold through automated provisioning pipelines.
- Guided Teradata-to-BigQuery migrations and machine learning deployment initiatives, ensuring petabyte-scale data transfer with zero disruption to business continuity.
- Audited and enhanced over 300 cloud controls, developing custom governance automation in 30 high-impact areas to achieve 95% compliance across security, data, and operational domains.
- Launched cross-departmental Agile “Kaizen” collaboration framework to align engineering, product, and architecture teams, improving delivery cadence and stakeholder communication.
- Reduced annual software costs roughly \$3M and prevented \$10M+ in licensing expenses by consolidating redundant platforms, optimizing cloud utilization, and enforcing automated scaling policies.
- Designed a standardized enterprise cloud adoption framework with persona-based templates and IaC archetypes, improving security posture and eliminating multiple high-priority audit findings.

JENIUS BANK IN SMBC AMERICAS GROUP | San Antonio, TX (Remote)

01/2022-05/2023

Director of Data Science (Vice President)

- Established and led the data science and advanced analytics function for a digital-only bank, developing and executing an enterprise ML strategy that reduced risk, automated key processes, and aligned directly with business and compliance goals.
- Authored a five-year BI and ML strategic roadmap that prioritized high-ROI predictive and prescriptive use cases while implementing model governance standards and cross-functional execution frameworks.
- Designed and deployed data quality frameworks for 35+ critical data feeds, applying systematic profiling and validation to ensure data integrity, regulatory compliance, and reliable model performance.
- Built and scaled the core BI and data science team, recruiting top talent across multiple disciplines and driving rapid capability expansion through structured hiring and workforce planning.
- Streamlined project management and visibility by translating 800+ business requests into 70+ user epics with clear milestones and success metrics.
- Automated over 1,000 data validation tests and developed an enterprise GCP integration testing framework to standardize analytics delivery across teams.
- Represented the organization at industry events, providing thought leadership on Google Cloud adoption, model security, and best practices for ML implementation.

GOOGLE | San Antonio, TX (Remote)

04/2021-01/2022

AI & Machine Learning Specialist (L5)

- Advised Fortune 500 financial and insurance clients on AI and ML strategy, developing implementation roadmaps that converted business challenges into measurable ROI through predictive modeling and automation.
- Designed and delivered cloud-based ML solutions leveraging Vertex AI, BigQuery ML, Document AI, and AutoML to accelerate model deployment and scale enterprise analytics on Google Cloud Platform.
- Led executive workshops and technical whiteboarding sessions for C-suite stakeholders to evaluate AI use cases, operationalize ML pipelines, and align technical feasibility with strategic outcomes.
- Delivered rapid prototypes and proof-of-concept models that demonstrated production-ready pathways for generative and predictive AI capabilities, expanding adoption across client portfolios.

USAA | San Antonio, TX

08/2017-04/2021

Staff Technical Architect

- Provided enterprise technical leadership across ML, Advanced Analytics, GIS, and BI functions, closing key infrastructure gaps and modernizing data and model architectures for scalability and compliance.
- Architected and deployed cloud-hosted discovery, development, and production environments for data science workloads, defining new cloud archetypes, MLOps standards, and model governance frameworks across 50+ analytics platforms.
- Accelerated ML model deployment timelines from 13 months to three weeks by implementing standardized validation workflows, CI/CD automation, and end-to-end observability strategies.

- Directed AWS S3 and Snowflake adoption by co-authoring technical white papers and aligning multi-department operations to a unified future-state architecture.
- Optimized enterprise data infrastructure, achieving \$1.2M in annual savings, eliminating redundant storage systems, and enabling consistent data lineage for regulatory compliance.
- Enhanced model performance and governance by introducing feature store development, centralized validation frameworks, and scalable Python and R production environments.
- Led team development and coaching to strengthen model governance, reproducibility, and ML best practices across all predictive analytics workstreams.

META STUDIOS, INC. | Baltimore, MD

03/2015-07/2017

Director, Data Science

- Led design and delivery of full-stack data science solutions for federal programs, combining predictive modeling, machine learning, and advanced analytics to optimize decision workflows and measurable ROI.
- Architected and deployed end-to-end data pipelines integrating MongoDB, Elasticsearch, and REST APIs, enabling high-volume data ingestion, analysis, and visualization.
- Reduced information delivery time from weeks to hours by developing custom analytics dashboards and user interfaces in Node.js and React.js, significantly improving operational efficiency and stakeholder accessibility.
- Collaborated with engineering and program leadership to modernize analytics infrastructure, ensuring scalability, security, and maintainability across multi-environment deployments.

EARLIER CAREER SUMMARY | Multiple Locations

10/1998-03/2015

Early career experience in intelligence analysis, software engineering, and data science across the U.S. Air Force, National Security Agency, Leidos, and private-sector partners. Developed and deployed custom applications using Python, JavaScript, and ArcGIS for geospatial data integration, NLP pattern recognition, data visualization, and mission analytics, reducing processing times from days to hours across multiple domains. Designed automated ETL pipelines and data workflows leveraging Hadoop and graph analysis for large-scale intelligence systems. As Branch Chief and Technical Director, led multiple 25 to 70-member teams in establishing cybersecurity operation teams, improving analytic efficiency, and implementing modernization strategies that standardized tradecraft and compliance across multiple critical environments worldwide.

RECENT CERTIFICATIONS

- Google Professional Machine Learning Engineer
- Google Professional Data Engineer

EDUCATION

TEXAS MCCOMBS (SCHOOL OF BUSINESS) | Austin, TX | 2025

Post-Graduate Program, AI & ML Business Applications

WESTERN GOVERNOR'S UNIVERSITY | Online | 2021

Master of Business Administration, IT

WESTERN GOVERNOR'S UNIVERSITY | Online | 2020

Master of Science, Data Analytics

WESTERN GOVERNOR'S UNIVERSITY | Online | 2018

Bachelor of Science, Software Engineering

EXCELSIOR UNIVERSITY | Albany, NY | 2005

Bachelor of Arts, Liberal Studies